

At/on/in (time)

A

Compare **at**, **on** and **in**:

- ☐ They arrived **at 5 o'clock**.
- ☐ They arrived **on Friday**.
- ☐ They arrived **in October**. / They arrived **in 1998**.

We use:

at for the time of day**at five o'clock** **at 11.45** **at midnight** **at lunchtime** **at sunset** etc.**on** for days and dates**on Friday** / **on Fridays** **on 16 May 2009** **on Christmas Day** **on my birthday****in** for longer periods (for example: months/years/seasons)

in October	in 1998	in the 18th century	in the past
in (the) winter	in the 1990s	in the Middle Ages	in (the) future

B

We use **at** in these expressions:**at night****at the weekend** / **at weekends****at Christmas****at the moment** / **at present****at the same time**

- ☐ I don't like working **at night**.
- ☐ Will you be here **at the weekend**?
- ☐ Do you give each other presents **at Christmas**?
- ☐ The manager isn't here **at the moment** / **at present**.
- ☐ Kate and I arrived **at the same time**.

C

We say:

in the morning(s)**in the afternoon(s)****in the evening(s)***but***on Friday morning(s)****on Sunday afternoon(s)****on Monday evening(s)** etc.

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ I'll see you in the morning . | ☐ I'll see you on Friday morning . |
| ☐ Do you work in the evenings ? | ☐ Do you work on Saturday evenings ? |

D

We do not use **at/on/in** before **last/next/this/every**:

- ☐ I'll see you **next Friday**. (*not* on next Friday)
- ☐ They got married **last March**.

In spoken English we often leave out **on** before days (**Sunday/Monday** etc.). So you can say:

- ☐ I'll see you **on Friday**. or I'll see you **Friday**.
- ☐ I don't work **on Monday mornings**. or I don't work **Monday mornings**.

E

In a few minutes / **in six months** etc.

- ☐ The train will be leaving **in a few minutes**. (= a few minutes from now)
- ☐ Andy has gone away. He'll be back **in a week**. (= a week from now)
- ☐ They'll be here **in a moment**. (= a moment from now)

You can also say: in six months' **time**, in a week's **time** etc.

- ☐ They're getting married in **six months' time**. or ... **in six months**.

We also use **in** ... to say how long it takes to do something:

- ☐ I learnt to drive **in four weeks**. (= it took me four weeks to learn)

In/at/on (position) 1

A

In



in a room
in a building
in a box



in a garden
in a town/country
in the city centre



in a pool
in the sea
in a river

- ☐ There's no-one **in the room** / **in the building** / **in the garden**.
- ☐ What have you got **in your hand** / **in your mouth**?
- ☐ When we were **in Italy**, we spent a few days **in Venice**.
- ☐ I have a friend who lives **in a small village in the mountains**.
- ☐ There were some people swimming **in the pool** / **in the sea** / **in the river**.

B

At



at the bus stop



at the door



at the roundabout

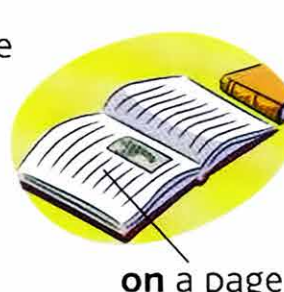
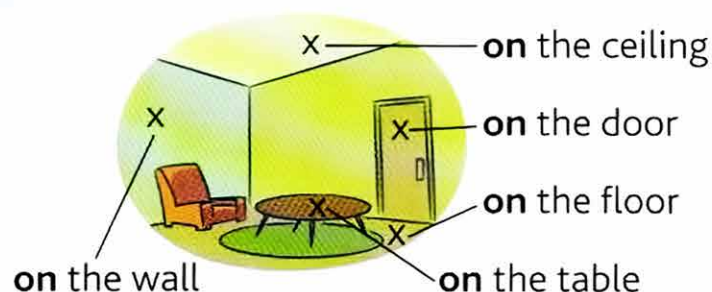


at reception

- ☐ Who is that man standing **at the bus stop** / **at the door** / **at the window**?
- ☐ Turn left **at the traffic lights** / **at the church** / **at the roundabout** / **at the junction**.
- ☐ We have to get off the bus **at the next stop**.
- ☐ When you leave the hotel, please leave your key **at reception**. (= at the reception desk)

C

On



- ☐ I sat **on the floor** / **on the ground** / **on the grass** / **on the beach** / **on a chair**.
- ☐ There's a dirty mark **on the wall** / **on the ceiling** / **on your nose** / **on your shirt**.
- ☐ Have you seen the notice **on the notice board** / **on the door**?
- ☐ You'll find details of TV programmes **on page seven** (of the newspaper).
- ☐ The hotel is **on a small island** in the middle of a lake.

D

Compare **in** and **at**:

- ☐ There were a lot of people **in the shop**. It was very crowded.
Go along this road, then turn left **at the shop**.
- ☐ I'll meet you **in the hotel lobby**.
I'll meet you **at the entrance to the hotel**.

Compare **in** and **on**:

- ☐ There is some water **in the bottle**.
There is a label **on the bottle**.

on the bottle

Compare **at** and **on**:

- ☐ There is somebody **at the door**. Shall I go and see who it is?
There is a notice **on the door**. It says 'Do not disturb'.

A

We say that somebody/something is:

in a line / in a row / in a queue**in the sky / in the world****in an office / in a department****in a book / in a paper (= newspaper) / in a magazine / in a letter****in bed****in the country / in the countryside****in a picture / in a photo / in a photograph**

- ☐ When I go to the cinema, I like to sit **in the front row**.
- ☐ James isn't up yet. He's still **in bed**.
- ☐ It was a lovely day. There wasn't a cloud **in the sky**.
- ☐ I've just started working **in the sales department**.
- ☐ Who is the woman **in that photo**?
- ☐ Have you seen this picture **in today's paper**?

**in a row**

B

on the left / on the right on the left-hand side / on the right-hand side**on the ground floor / on the first floor / on the second floor etc.****on a map / on a menu / on a list****on a farm**

- ☐ In Britain we drive **on the left**. or ... **on the left-hand side**.
- ☐ Our apartment is **on the second floor** of the building.
- ☐ Here's a shopping list. Don't buy anything that's not **on the list**.
- ☐ Have you ever worked **on a farm**?

We say that a place is **on a river / on a road / on the coast**:

- ☐ Budapest is **on the** (river) **Danube**.
- ☐ The town where you live – is it **on the coast** or inland?

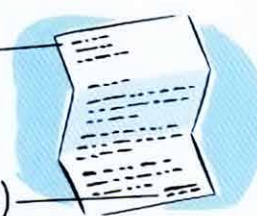
Also **on the way**:

- ☐ We stopped to buy some things in a shop **on the way** home.

C

at the top (of) / at the bottom (of) / at the end (of)

- ☐ Write your name **at the top of the page**.
- ☐ Jane's house is **at the other end of the street**.

at the top (of the page)**at the bottom (of the page)**

D

in the front / in the back of a car

- ☐ I was sitting **in the back** (of the car) when we crashed.

at the front / at the back of a building / theatre / group of people etc.

- ☐ The garden is **at the back of the house**.
- ☐ Let's sit **at the front** (of the cinema).
- ☐ We were **at the back**, so we couldn't see very well.

on the front / on the back of a letter / piece of paper etc.

- ☐ I wrote the date **on the back of the photo**.

**at the back****at the front**

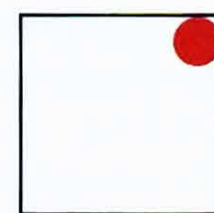
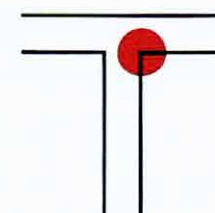
E

in the corner of a room

- ☐ The TV is **in the corner** of the room.

at the corner or on the corner of a street

- ☐ There is a small shop **at/on the corner** of the street.

**in the corner****at/on the corner**

In/at/on (position) 3

A

In hospital / at work etc.

We say that somebody is **in hospital** / **in prison** / **in jail**:

- ☐ Anna's mother is **in hospital**.

We say that somebody is **at work** / **at school** / **at university** / **at college**:

- ☐ I'll be **at work** until 5.30.
☐ Julia is studying chemistry **at university**.

We say that somebody **is at home** or **is home** (with or without **at**), but we say **do something at home** (with **at**):

- ☐ I'll **be at home** all evening. *or* I'll **be home** all evening.
☐ Shall we go to a restaurant or **eat at home**?

B

At a party / at a concert etc.

We say that somebody is **at** an event (**at a party** / **at a conference** etc.):

- ☐ Were there many people **at the party** / **at the meeting** / **at the wedding**?
☐ I saw Steve **at a conference** / **at a concert** on Saturday.

C

In and at for buildings

You can often use **in** or **at** with buildings. For example, you can eat **in a restaurant** or **at a restaurant**; you can buy something **in a supermarket** or **at a supermarket**. We usually say **at** when we say where an event takes place (for example: a concert, a film, a party, a meeting):

- ☐ We went to a concert **at the National Concert Hall**.
☐ The meeting took place **at the company's head office** in Frankfurt.
☐ There was a robbery **at the supermarket**.

We say **at the station** / **at the airport**:

- ☐ There's no need to meet me **at the station**. I can get a taxi.

We say **at** somebody's house:

- ☐ I was **at Helen's house** last night. *or* I was **at Helen's** last night.

Also **at the doctor's** / **at the hairdresser's** etc.

We use **in** when we are thinking about the building itself. Compare:

- ☐ We had dinner **at the hotel**.
 All the rooms **in the hotel** have air conditioning. (*not at the hotel*)
☐ I was **at Helen's (house)** last night.
 It's always cold **in Helen's house**. The heating doesn't work well. (*not at Helen's house*)

D

In and at for towns etc.

We normally use **in** with cities, towns and villages:

- ☐ The Louvre is a famous art museum **in Paris**. (*not at Paris*)
☐ Sam's parents live **in a village** in the south of France. (*not at a village*)

We use **at** when we think of the place as a point or station on a journey:

- ☐ Does this train stop **at Oxford**? (= at Oxford station)

E

On a bus / in a car etc.

We usually say **on a bus** / **on a train** / **on a plane** / **on a ship** *but* **in a car** / **in a taxi**:

- ☐ **The bus** was very full. There were too many people **on it**.
☐ Laura arrived **in a taxi**.

We say **on a bike** (= bicycle) / **on a motorbike** / **on a horse**:

- ☐ Jane passed me **on her bike**.